THE BJP

A Timeline

I. Nehru's Power Struggle with Congress Traditionalists, Jan Sangh and the Hindu Right

> Pre-1950s:

27 September 1925: The RSS was founded by Dr Keshav Baliram Hedgewar on Vijayadashami day in Nagpur. The name 'Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh' was selected on 17 April 1926. The tradition of commencing daily activities with a salutation to the saffron flag (Bhagwa Dhwaj) and concluding with the RSS prayer, Prarthana, in Hindi and Marathi was instituted in 1926.

1928: Vinayak Damodar Savarkar publishes *Hindutva: Who is a Hindu?*, which remains a critical theoretical underpinning for much of Hindutva thinking. It was first published in 1923 as *Essentials of Hinduism* and republished with a new title in 1928.

1929: Syama Prasad Mookerjee elected as Congress member of the Bengal Legislative Council.

1930: Mookerjee resigns and leaves the Congress.

1931: Mookerjee re-elected independent legislator from same constituency.

1940–1944: Mookerjee is acting president of the Hindu Mahasabha.

15 August 1947: Mookerjee joins Nehru's cabinet as minister for industries and supplies as a member of the Hindu Mahasabha, along with N.C. Chatterjee.